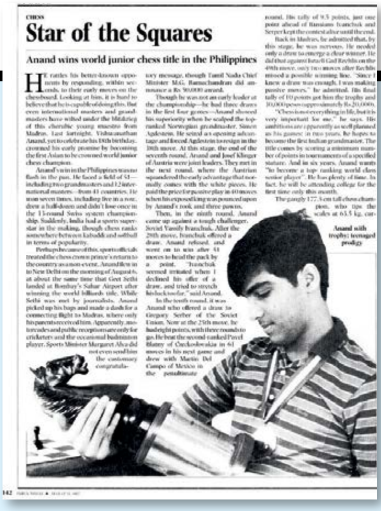


CHESS

Star of the Squares

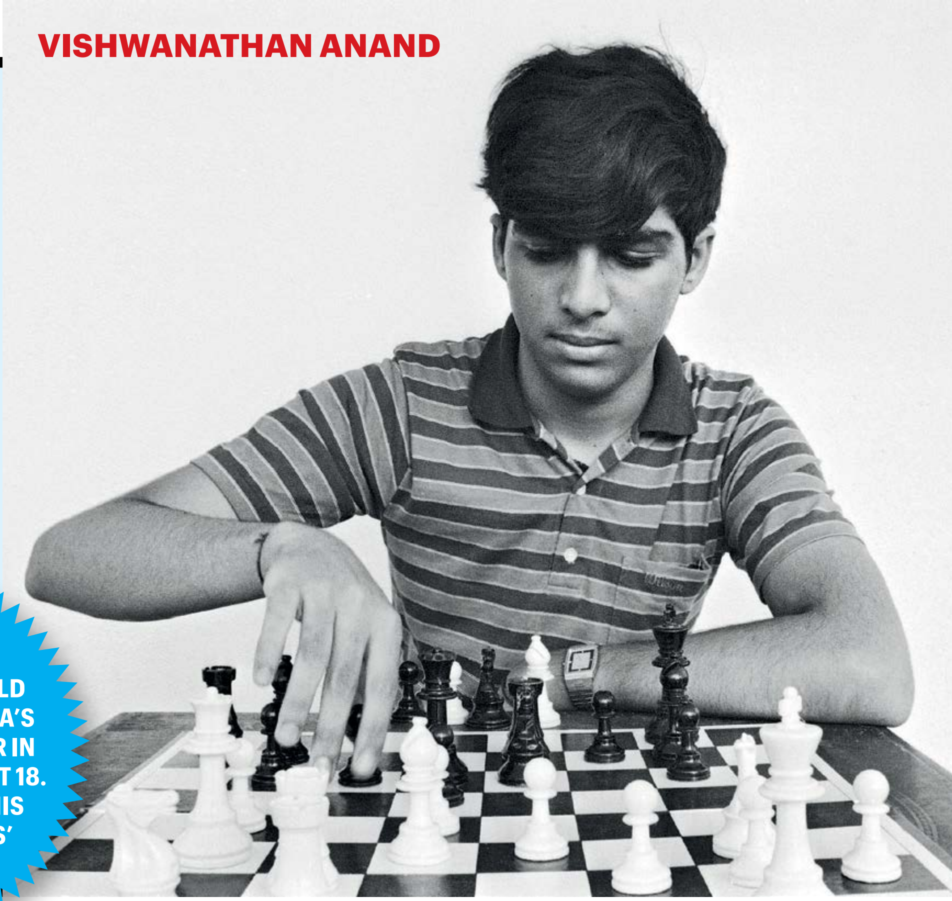
Anand wins world junior chess title in the Philippines

Anand with trophy: teenaged prodigy

▲ INDIA TODAY, *Aug. 31, 1987*

ANAND BECAME THE CHESS JUNIOR WORLD CHAMPION AND INDIA'S FIRST GRANDMASTER IN 1987, AND HE WAS JUST 18. HE QUALIFIED FOR HIS FIRST 'CANDIDATES' IN 1993

VISHWANATHAN ANAND



SHYAM TEKWANI

came back with bagfuls of golds at the 1985 Asian Athletics meet (100m, 200m, 400m and 4x400m) and the 1986 Seoul Asiad, with chants of 'Usha, Usha' ringing out in the stadium. Luck, though, deserted her again at the 1988 Seoul Olympics, a heel injury laying low her plans before the finals. Usha continued to compete (a last gold came at the 1998 Asian C'ships), but never hit that worldbeater stride again.

In other sporting news, a young Vishwanathan Anand was making lightning-fast moves on the chessboard, becoming the Junior World Champion and India's first Grandmaster in 1987, when he was just 18. Anand would go on to qualify for his first Candidates tournament (to see who challenges the champion) in 1993 but would lose to ex-world champion Anatoly Karpov in the quarters. Time, though, would prove that the future five-time world champion was just warming up.

Closing out 1994, there was heartbreak for Indian cricket fans. Kapil Dev, India's, and perhaps the world's, finest all-rounder, announced he was leaving the field. The country never could find a player to fill those shoes again. ■

INDIA TODAY ARCHIVES

P.T. USHA Fans throng to get an autograph from the 'Payyoli Express' at the Seoul Asian Games, 1986